

“[The Pathet Lao] said ‘We **need young soldiers**—we need every man around to be a soldier.’”

CHUE VANG ON BEING ORDERED TO FIGHT FOR THE PATHET LAO AT AGE 8, MISSOULA TIMES, MAY 27, 2015

» AFTER

From 1975 to 1996, the US resettled some 250,000 Lao refugees in the United States.

URBANIZED AND EDUCATED

Many refugees from Laos were ethnic Lao people: officials from the former government and those from the educated classes. Initially housed in refugee camps in Thailand, by 1995 more than 183,000 had been **resettled worldwide**.

HMONG DIASPORA

After some hesitation based on the belief that the Hmong people would not be able to adapt to life in America, the United States accepted some 140,000 Hmong from camps in Thailand. They settled mainly in California, Minnesota, Wisconsin, and North Carolina. Among them was General Vang Pao, whose death in California in 2010 was widely mourned by the Hmong.



HMONG WOMEN AT VANG PAO'S FUNERAL